



Embassy for the United States of America
Accra, Ghana

March 14, 2023

Dear Ms. Hillary Adare:

Congratulations! You have been selected to participate in the 2023 Mandela Washington Fellowship for Young African Leaders.

The Mandela Washington Fellowship for Young African Leaders is the flagship program of the Young African Leaders Initiative (YALI). As a Mandela Washington Fellow, you will arrive in the United States on or around June 21, 2023 and will spend six weeks participating in a Leadership Institute hosted by a U.S. higher education institution. During the Institute, you will hone your leadership skills and network with other young leaders from Sub-Saharan Africa and the United States. After your Leadership Institute concludes, you will participate in the Mandela Washington Fellowship Summit, during which you will have the opportunity to interact with U.S. leaders in business, government, and nonprofit sectors. Following the Summit, a limited number of competitively-selected Fellows will remain in the United States for four weeks to participate in a Professional Development Experience (PDE) at a U.S. private, public, or nonprofit organization before returning home. If you applied to be considered for the PDE, you will receive a separate notification of your selection for that opportunity.

Upon completion of the U.S.-based program, Fellows will return to their country of residence to continue building the skills and connections developed during the program. As Fellowship Alumni, you will also have access to ongoing professional development, networking, and collaboration opportunities with support from the U.S. Department of State and affiliated partners.

You will receive more information in the next few days from IREX, our implementing partner, regarding your participation in the Mandela Washington Fellowship and the forms that you need to complete. In order to finalize your participation, you will need to accept the program's terms and conditions and receive a J-1 visa to the United States. In addition to receiving a J-1 visa, Fellows are responsible for ensuring they meet current requirements for entry to the United States, including any vaccination requirements from the United States Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC). If you have questions after you receive more information from IREX, please email them at MWF2023@irex.org.

On behalf of the U.S. Government, I congratulate you again on your selection as a Mandela Washington Fellow.

Sincerely,

R. Laneice Brooker
Cultural Affairs Attaché